

2. **Programmable Keys:** Many gaming keyboards offer programmable keys or macro support, allowing you to customize key bindings or assign sequences of actions to a single keystroke. This is a huge advantage in gaming, where quick reactions can make the difference between victory and defeat. Even in non-gaming tasks, macros can streamline complex workflows, saving time and effort.
3. **Dedicated Media Controls:** For users who consume a lot of media, dedicated media controls (such as play, pause, skip, and volume adjustments) can be a valuable addition. These are typically found in higher-end keyboards and provide quick access to media functions without interrupting your workflow or game.
4. **Removable or Braided Cables:** Many high-quality keyboards come with removable or braided cables, which offer improved durability and portability. Braided cables are more resistant to fraying, while removable cables make transporting the keyboard easier, reducing wear and tear.
4. **N-Key Rollover and Anti-Ghosting:** For gamers, n-key rollover (NKRO) and anti-ghosting are essential features. NKRO allows the keyboard to register multiple key presses simultaneously, which is crucial in fast-paced gaming scenarios. Anti-ghosting prevents unintended key presses from being registered, ensuring that each keystroke is accurately detected, even when pressing several keys at once.

Wired vs Wireless Keyboards

When it comes to connectivity, you have two main options: wired or wireless.

1. **Wired Keyboards:** Wired keyboards are connected to your PC via USB and are generally considered more reliable due to their consistent connection and zero input lag. For gaming, a wired connection is typically the go-to option since it ensures fast, uninterrupted communication between the keyboard and the computer. Additionally, wired keyboards don't require batteries or recharging, making them a hassle-free option for most users.
2. **Wireless Keyboards:** Wireless keyboards offer more flexibility, providing a clutter-free desk setup and portability. Most wireless keyboards connect via Bluetooth or 2.4GHz wireless receivers. Bluetooth is more commonly found in office or casual-use keyboards, while 2.4GHz wireless is preferred for gaming and other low-latency applications due to its faster response times.

The downside of wireless keyboards is the need for battery management. Many models come with rechargeable batteries, but some still use replaceable AA or AAA batteries. Premium wireless keyboards often offer long battery life, with some models lasting several weeks on a single charge, depending on use.

3. **Dual-Mode Connectivity:** Some keyboards offer dual-mode connectivity, allowing users to switch between wired and wireless operation. This provides the convenience of wireless use while retaining the option for a wired connection when needed, such as during gaming sessions where low latency is a priority.

MONITORS

Making the right display choice heavily depends upon the type of application intended. The parameters vary wildly depending upon whether you're looking for a display that will serve as a TV in the living room, one that is meant to go with your gaming rig, or if you happen to be the sort of person who bases his mobile phone purchase largely upon the quality of the screen. Looking at gaming monitors, the choice is primarily restricted to LED-backlit LCD panels. However, you can always consider OLED TVs, which offer significantly better image fidelity provided you're willing to spare no expense. We will tackle the differences between the two technologies a bit further down, but first let's figure out the first step in choosing the right monitor – that is, which panel should you go for?

TN Panels

The most common panel type in the market, TN's are as old as commercially viable LCD technology itself. If your TV manufacturer hasn't listed out some exotic technology underpinning the panel, chances are it's the good ol' TN panel. Because this panel type's simplicity and the fact that it has existed for donkey's years, this allows it to be ubiquitous due to cheaper manufacturing cost. However, low cost isn't its only trick. TN panels are by far the quickest when it comes to response time. That is, the pixels within this panel are capable of changing their state quickly and thereby reduce motion artefacts such as blur. That's why nearly all gaming monitors that support some sort of high refresh rate technology happen to be TN panels. Monitors that also incorporate active LCD shutter based 3D support usually employ TN panels because the 3D implementation requires monitors capable of frame rates upwards of 120 Hz. Modern TN panels catering to gamers promise better motion handling and smoother experience by incorporating true 144 Hz refresh rates. This isn't meant for 3D implementation, but to offer fluid gameplay experience for FPS gamers, where faster screen refreshes makes the difference between a frag and getting fragged.

It's cheap, fast, and perfect for gaming, so what's the catch, you ask. Well, the prime weakness of this panel tragically happens to be picture quality. Make no mistake, the overall performance has improved by a wide margin over the years, but this technology still pales in comparison to other panel types. Mind you, a decent TN panel can still provide sharp and detailed picture with adequate contrast around the 1000:1 mark. However, the colour reproduction isn't as accurate as the competition. In fact, the overall vibrancy and colour performance is noticeably lacking. That, sadly, isn't even its main problem. Restricted viewing angles are by far its biggest failing. Don't go by the specs, where you can find generous viewing angles mentioned, but the amount of colour shift in practical terms is disconcertingly high. View these panels from reasonably off centre position and the colour shift gets worse to the point of complete inversion, wherein the image appears as a film negative. While controlling horizontal viewing angles is relatively easy in a monitor for a single user, controlling the vertical viewing angle is a lot more difficult. If you have a large enough monitor (say 27-inch), colour